

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–88

"Why did plots and foreign threats push Elizabeth towards war?"

**MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 2: CHALLENGES TO
ELIZABETH AT HOME AND ABROAD, 1569–88**

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 118 Crucial Questions

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- ☐ **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- ☐ **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- ☐ **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	Which Protestant Bishop of Durham did the Northern Earls strongly resent?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which two Catholic nobles led the Revolt of the Northern Earls in 1569?	☐	☐	☐	
3	What major religious building did the Northern Earls capture to celebrate a Catholic Mass?	☐	☐	☐	
4	Roughly how many rebels did Elizabeth execute after the Northern Earls' revolt?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What was the theological meaning of the 1570 Papal excommunication?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What strict law was passed in 1581 regarding Catholic conversions?	☐	☐	☐	
7	Who was the Italian banker that orchestrated a plot in 1571?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Which foreign commander was supposed to lead 10,000 Spanish troops during the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
9	Which high-ranking English nobleman was executed in 1572 for his involvement in the Ridolfi Plot?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which plot in 1583 involved the French Duke of Guise invading England with Spanish money?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What document was created after the Throckmorton Plot stating Mary would be killed if Elizabeth was assassinated?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Who was Elizabeth's Secretary of State and Spymaster?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
13	What term is used for spies, like Gilbert Gifford, who secretly encourage others to commit treason?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Who was the expert cryptographer that deciphered Mary's letters for Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
15	Which 1586 plot provided the final, irrefutable written proof of Mary's guilt?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What specific Act of Parliament was used to try and convict Mary, Queen of Scots?	☐	☐	☐	
17	In what year was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?	☐	☐	☐	
18	Name two "new men" at court whose rise to power angered the old northern nobility.	☐	☐	☐	
19	What did Walsingham find in Francis Throckmorton's house that caused immense panic?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Which Spanish Ambassador was expelled following the discovery of the Throckmorton Plot?	☐	☐	☐	

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Score: _____ / 20

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Date: _____

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What was Elizabeth's immediate reaction to Mary's arrival?	☐	☐	☐	
23	Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a massive threat to Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
24	What was the Casket Letters affair?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What was the Papal Bull of 1570?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What was the 'Crucifix Controversy'?	☐	☐	☐	
27	What were the Royal Injunctions?	☐	☐	☐	
28	How much debt did Elizabeth inherit?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What was the 'Auld Alliance'?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What did William Harvey discover?	☐	☐	☐	
31	Who was the devout Catholic King of Spain during Elizabeth's reign?	☐	☐	☐	
32	What term describes sailors officially licensed by the government to rob enemy ships?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Which famous English privateer stole roughly £400,000 of Spanish treasure during his circumnavigation?	☐	☐	☐	
34	What region did Spain control that Elizabeth sent troops to support in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	
35	What was the name of the 1585 treaty where Elizabeth officially supported the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
36	Which English commander was sent to the Netherlands with 7,400 troops?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What 1587 event removed the Catholic alternative to the English throne, prompting Philip to invade?	☐	☐	☐	
38	In what year did Francis Drake raid Cadiz to delay the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
39	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
40	In what year did the Spanish Armada set sail?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

KT2.2: Relations with Spain

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	Who was the inexperienced Spanish commander of the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
42	Whose army was the Armada supposed to pick up from the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in as they travelled up the English Channel?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What type of new, fast, and highly manoeuvrable warships did the English use?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Where did the Spanish mistakenly drop their anchors, making them vulnerable?	☐	☐	☐	
46	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation at Calais?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What major naval battle took place immediately after the fireships scattered the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
48	Why couldn't the Armada pick up the Spanish army in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to get home?	☐	☐	☐	
50	What destroyed the majority of the Spanish ships as they tried to return home?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What was the Ridolfi Plot (1571)?	☐	☐	☐	
53	What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
54	What was the Babington Plot (1586)?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Who was Francis Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England in 1568?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What was the Casket Letters affair?	☐	☐	☐	
58	Who was the Pope that excommunicated Elizabeth in 1570?	☐	☐	☐	
59	What was the Act of Uniformity?	☐	☐	☐	
60	Who published the Germ Theory?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	Under which previous monarch were England and Spain actually allies?	☐	☐	☐	
62	What did Elizabeth seize from Italian ships sheltering in English ports in 1568?	☐	☐	☐	
63	How much Spanish gold and silver did Francis Drake capture between 1577 and 1580?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Which Dutch Protestant rebel leader was assassinated in 1584?	☐	☐	☐	
65	Which 1584 treaty allied Catholic France and Spain together?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What 1585 agreement saw Elizabeth officially pledge military support to the Dutch rebels?	☐	☐	☐	
67	How many soldiers did Elizabeth agree to send to the Netherlands in 1585?	☐	☐	☐	
68	Which English commander was sent to lead the troops in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
69	What title did Robert Dudley accept in the Netherlands that infuriated Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
70	Name one of the English officers who defected to the Spanish side, damaging Dutch trust.	☐	☐	☐	
71	What deep-water port did Dudley successfully prevent the Spanish from capturing?	☐	☐	☐	
72	Why was the defense of Ostend so important for England's future?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
73	In what month and year did Francis Drake launch his preemptive raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What famous phrase was used to describe Drake's raid on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Roughly how many Spanish ships did Drake destroy in Cadiz harbour?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What crucial supply item did Drake destroy at Cadiz that later caused Spanish food to rot?	☐	☐	☐	
77	How long did Drake's raid on Cadiz delay the launch of the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Why was this delay so significant for Elizabeth's government?	☐	☐	☐	
79	Why was Philip II of Spain angry with Elizabeth?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What was a 'privateer'?	☐	☐	☐	

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KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	Which famous English privateer constantly raided Spanish treasure ships?	☐	☐	☐	
82	What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?	☐	☐	☐	
83	How much gold did Drake capture from the Spanish ship Cacafuego?	☐	☐	☐	
84	Who was Francis Walsingham?	☐	☐	☐	
85	What was the Babington Plot (1586)?	☐	☐	☐	
86	What was the Revolt of the Northern Earls (1569)?	☐	☐	☐	
87	Why was Mary, Queen of Scots a threat?	☐	☐	☐	
88	What was the 'Vestment Controversy'?	☐	☐	☐	
89	Who had Elizabeth rejected a marriage proposal from in 1559?	☐	☐	☐	
90	Which Pope gave his blessing to the Armada, turning it into a Catholic crusade?	☐	☐	☐	
91	How much money did the Pope promise Philip if the Armada was successful?	☐	☐	☐	
92	What 1584 treaty between France and Spain isolated England and pushed Philip closer to war?	☐	☐	☐	
93	The execution of which monarch in 1587 gave Philip II his final political motivation to invade?	☐	☐	☐	
94	What was the name of the inexperienced commander chosen by Philip to lead the Armada?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
95	How many ships made up the Spanish Armada?	☐	☐	☐	
96	What highly effective, defensive shape did the Spanish fleet sail in?	☐	☐	☐	
97	Who commanded the Spanish land army waiting in the Netherlands?	☐	☐	☐	
98	What type of small rebel ships blockaded the Spanish army in the shallow coastal waters?	☐	☐	☐	
99	At which port did the Armada mistakenly drop anchor to wait for the land army?	☐	☐	☐	
100	What devastating tactic did the English use at midnight to break the Spanish formation?	☐	☐	☐	

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Date: _____

KT2.4: The Armada

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
101	How many fireships did the English send into the Spanish fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
102	What was the name of the major naval battle that took place the day after the fireships were used?	☐	☐	☐	
103	Why were English cannons able to fire more quickly than the Spanish during this battle?	☐	☐	☐	
104	Which way was the Armada forced to sail to escape the English fleet?	☐	☐	☐	
105	What nickname did the English give to the storms that destroyed the fleeing Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
106	Where did Elizabeth deliver her famous speech to her troops ("I have the heart and stomach of a king")?	☐	☐	☐	
107	What famous piece of propaganda was painted to celebrate the victory?	☐	☐	☐	
108	Did the defeat of the Armada in 1588 mean the end of the war with Spain?	☐	☐	☐	
109	What did Drake do in Cadiz in 1587?	☐	☐	☐	
110	What phrase did Drake use to describe his attack on Cadiz?	☐	☐	☐	
111	When was Mary, Queen of Scots executed?	☐	☐	☐	
112	How did Mary's execution affect relations with Spain?	☐	☐	☐	
113	What was the Treaty of Nonsuch (1585)?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
114	Which English privateer constantly raided Spanish ships?	☐	☐	☐	
115	What was the Throckmorton Plot (1583)?	☐	☐	☐	
116	Why did Mary, Queen of Scots flee to England?	☐	☐	☐	
117	What title did Elizabeth take in the Act of Supremacy?	☐	☐	☐	
118	How much debt did Elizabeth inherit in 1558?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT2.1: Plots and revolts at home

1. James Pilkington
2. The Earl of Northumberland and the Earl of Westmorland
3. Durham Cathedral
4. 450
5. Being formally excluded from the Catholic Church and unable to receive sacraments
6. It became high treason to convert anyone to Catholicism
7. Roberto Ridolfi
8. The Duke of Alba
9. The Duke of Norfolk
10. The Throckmorton Plot
11. The Bond of Association
12. Sir Francis Walsingham
13. Agents provocateurs
14. Thomas Phelippes
15. The Babington Plot
16. The Act for the Preservation of the Queen's Safety
17. 1587
18. William Cecil, Robert Dudley, or John Forster
19. A list of Catholic sympathisers / proof of the "enemy within"
20. Mendoza
21. Following a rebellion by Scottish nobles who forced her to abdicate.
22. She imprisoned her in the north to prevent her from rallying English Catholics.
23. She had a strong, legitimate claim to the English throne and was Catholic.
24. Letters allegedly proving Mary was involved in the murder of her husband, Lord Darnley.
25. The Pope's decree excommunicating Elizabeth.
26. A Puritan protest against Elizabeth's demand for crucifixes in churches.
27. Rules enforcing the Religious Settlement on the clergy.
28. £300,000.
29. The Catholic alliance between France and Scotland.

30. The circulation of blood.
31. King Philip II
32. Privateers
33. Sir Francis Drake
34. The Netherlands
35. The Treaty of Nonsuch
36. The Earl of Leicester / Robert Dudley
37. The execution of Mary, Queen of Scots
38. 1587
39. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
40. 1588

KT2.2: Relations with Spain

41. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
42. The Duke of Parma's army
43. A crescent formation
44. Galleons
45. Calais
46. Fireships
47. The Battle of Gravelines
48. Poor communication / Parma's army was not ready in time
49. North, around the coasts of Scotland and Ireland
50. Fierce storms / The weather / The "Protestant Wind"
51. A Catholic rebellion led by the Earls of Northumberland and Westmorland to depose Elizabeth.
52. A plot to assassinate Elizabeth and replace her with Mary, backed by Spanish troops.
53. A French Catholic plot backed by Spain to invade England and free Mary.
54. A plot to assassinate Elizabeth; Mary's coded letters approving the plot were intercepted.
55. Elizabeth's spymaster who uncovered the plots against her using ciphers and spies.
56. She was overthrown by Scottish nobles.
57. Letters claiming Mary killed her husband.
58. Pope Pius V.
59. The 1559 law setting out how church services must look and sound.
60. Louis Pasteur.

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

61. Mary Tudor
62. The Genoese Loan
63. £400,000
64. William of Orange
65. The Treaty of Joinville
66. The Treaty of Nonsuch
67. 7,400 troops
68. Robert Dudley, Earl of Leicester
69. Governor General
70. William Stanley or Rowland York

71. Ostend
72. It meant the Spanish Armada wouldn't have a deep-water port to pick up troops from a year later
73. April 1587
74. "Singeing the King of Spain's beard"
75. 30 ships
76. Seasoned wooden barrel staves
77. By roughly one year
78. It bought England vital time to prepare their navy and coastal defences
79. She rejected his marriage proposal, turned England Protestant, and supported Dutch rebels.
80. An armed private ship licensed by the government to attack and rob enemy ships.

KT2.3: Outbreak of war with Spain, 1585–88

- 81. Sir Francis Drake.
- 82. Elizabeth officially agreed to send an English army to help the Dutch rebels fight Spain.
- 83. £140,000.
- 84. Elizabeth's Secretary of State and spymaster.
- 85. The final plot that led to Mary, Queen of Scots' execution.
- 86. The only major rebellion on English soil against Elizabeth, led by Catholic nobles.
- 87. She was a Catholic figurehead with a strong claim to the throne.
- 88. Puritan priests refusing to wear Catholic-style robes.
- 89. King Philip II of Spain
- 90. Pope Sixtus V
- 91. One million gold ducats
- 92. The Treaty of Joinville
- 93. Mary, Queen of Scots
- 94. The Duke of Medina Sidonia
- 95. 130
- 96. A crescent formation
- 97. The Duke of Parma
- 98. Dutch flyboats
- 99. Calais
- 100. Fireships



KT2.4: The Armada

- 101. Eight
- 102. The Battle of Gravelines
- 103. They were mounted on smaller gun carriages, allowing them space to recoil and reload
- 104. Northwards, around Scotland and Ireland
- 105. The "Protestant Wind"
- 106. Tilbury
- 107. The Armada Portrait
- 108. No, the war continued for another 15 years and Philip built more armadas
- 109. He launched a surprise attack on the Spanish fleet, destroying 30 ships and delaying the Armada.
- 110. 'Singeing the King of Spain's beard.'
- 111. February 1587.

- 112. It gave Philip II the final moral justification he needed to launch the Armada.
- 113. Elizabeth's agreement to send troops to support the Dutch Protestant rebels.
- 114. Sir Francis Drake.
- 115. A plot for a French invasion backed by Spanish money.
- 116. She was forced to abdicate by Scottish lords.
- 117. Supreme Governor.
- 118. £300,000.

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 118 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/118)	Parent/Guardian Signature	Target for Next Time
1				
2				
3				

Operative Reflection

My ultimate strength in this unit is...

The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...